Article 2 upholds the eight objectives of the organization. These objectives are to:

1. Strengthen the peace and security of the continent.
2. Promote and consolidate representative democracy, with due respect for the principle of non-intervention.
3. Prevent the possible causes of difficulties and to ensure the pacific settlement of disputes that may arise among the member states.
4. Provide for common action on the part of those states, in the event of aggression.
5. Seek the solution of political, judicial and economic problems that may arise among them.
6. Promote, by cooperative action, their economic, social and cultural development.
7. Eradicate extreme poverty, which constitutes an obstacle to the full democratic development of the peoples of the hemisphere.
8. Achieve an effective limitation of conventional weapons that will make it possible to devote the largest amount of resources to the economic and social development of the member states.

The OAS tries to strengthen cooperation among the member states to enhance democratic values, defend common interests, and debate the major issues facing the region and the world. The OAS is the region's principal multilateral forum for strengthening democracy, promoting human rights, and confronting shared problems such as poverty, terrorism, illegal drugs and corruption. It plays a leading role in carrying out mandates established by the leaders of the hemisphere through the Summits of the Americas.